

Conclusion

Organizations increasingly recognize that employee skill-building is essential for keeping pace with changing business needs and new technologies. However, many are still struggling to translate that commitment into meaningful results. Despite growing investments in learning technology and AI, learning often remains disconnected from business priorities and day-to-day work.

Future success will depend less on offering more training and more on helping employees continuously build and apply new skills. Organizations that focus learning on real business challenges, support managers in employee development, and make learning easier to access during the workday will be better prepared to address skill gaps and adapt to change.

Technology is also changing how employees learn. Looking ahead, David Creelman, CEO of Creelman Research, predicts that learning will become much more conversational and immediate.

“Most learning will come directly from chatting with a large language model with only a bit of direction from L&D on how to engage with the model.” – David Creelman

However, the experts caution that simply producing more content with AI is unlikely to create better outcomes. Instead, L&D professionals must rethink how learning is delivered and measured. As Creelman advises to *“invest in discovering how AI transforms how learning can be delivered, don't just use AI to generate a lot more learning content.”*

Similarly, Matthew Casey-Sudvary emphasizes the importance of starting with business outcomes rather than technology adoption. He says, *“Define the problem and how you will know your program/tech is a success then measure and report.”* Perhaps the biggest shift will be the evolution of L&D itself. JD Dillon argues that capability building can no longer operate as an isolated function:

“Break out of the L&D silo and adopt an enablement mindset in collaboration with functions like communications, knowledge management, IT, and operations.”
– JD Dillon

Becky Willis provides pragmatic advice for teams trying to update their infrastructure, warning professionals to stop getting stuck in legacy upgrade cycles: *“Stop looking for a new LMS. Find a new solution that can either hit all the AI checkmarks by itself or add it on top of your dinosaur LMS.”* She also cautions leaders to beware of red flags from vendor AI claims and strongly advises them to get help when navigating this shifting market.

As the pace of change continues to increase, the role of L&D will shift from delivering training to helping employees learn, adapt, and perform more effectively every day. Organizations that embed learning into daily tools, hold managers accountable for team development, and measure skill gaps instead of course completions will close capability gaps faster than those still waiting to act.